

Psalms 45

The Royal Wedding

Thou art fairer than the children of men

KJV · Standalone study handout

1 · THE WORD (KJV)

- 1 *My heart is inditing a good matter: I speak of the things which I have made touching the king: my tongue is the pen of a ready writer.*
- 2 *Thou art fairer than the children of men: grace is poured into thy lips: therefore God hath blessed thee for ever.*
- 3 *Gird thy sword upon thy thigh, O most mighty, with thy glory and thy majesty.*
- 4 *And in thy majesty ride prosperously because of truth and meekness and righteousness; and thy right hand shall teach thee terrible things.*
- 5 *Thine arrows are sharp in the heart of the king's enemies; whereby the people fall under thee.*
- 6 *Thy throne, O God, is for ever and ever: the sceptre of thy kingdom is a right sceptre.*
- 7 *Thou lovest righteousness, and hatest wickedness: therefore God, thy God, hath anointed thee with the oil of gladness above thy fellows.*
- 8 *All thy garments smell of myrrh, and aloes, and cassia, out of the ivory palaces, whereby they have made thee glad.*
- 9 *Kings' daughters were among thy honourable women: upon thy right hand did stand the queen in gold of Ophir.*
- 10 *Hearken, O daughter, and consider, and incline thine ear; forget also thine own people, and thy father's house;*
- 11 *So shall the king greatly desire thy beauty: for he is thy Lord; and worship thou him.*
- 12 *And the daughter of Tyre shall be there with a gift; even the rich among the people shall intreat thy favour.*
- 13 *The king's daughter is all glorious within: her clothing is of wrought gold.*
- 14 *She shall be brought unto the king in raiment of needlework: the virgins her companions that follow her shall be brought unto thee.*
- 15 *With gladness and rejoicing shall they be brought: they shall enter into the king's palace.*
- 16 *Instead of thy fathers shall be thy children, whom thou mayest make princes in all the earth.*
- 17 *I will make thy name to be remembered in all generations: therefore shall the people praise thee for ever and ever.*

2 · CONTEXT

Psalm 45 is a royal wedding song celebrating a Davidic king's marriage, but the New Testament reads it messianically: Hebrews 1:8–9 applies verses 6–7 directly to Christ's eternal throne and His anointing above His fellows. The psalm addresses first the bridegroom-king's beauty, speech, and righteous conquest, then turns to counsel the bride and describe the joyful wedding procession. Henry and the broader tradition read it typologically of Christ and His Bride the Church, while still honoring its original setting as a literal royal celebration.

3 · VERSE-BY-VERSE COMMENTARY

The notes below cover the whole chapter in one place—read with the KJV text above.

Verse 1-2

The psalmist's heart overflows with “a good matter,” his tongue like the pen of a ready writer; the king is fairer than the children of men, with grace poured into his lips, and God has blessed him forever.

Verse 3-5

A call to the king to gird his sword and ride out prosperously for truth, meekness, and righteousness; his right hand teaches him terrible things, and his sharp arrows fall among his enemies, causing peoples to fall under him.

Verse 6-7

“Thy throne, O God, is for ever and ever: the sceptre of thy kingdom is a right sceptre”—words Hebrews applies to Christ. He loves righteousness and hates wickedness; therefore God, even his God, has anointed him with the oil of gladness above his fellows.

Verse 8-9

His garments smell of myrrh, aloes, and cassia, out of the ivory palaces that have made him glad; kings' daughters are among his honorable women, and the queen stands at his right hand in gold of Ophir.

Verse 10-12

Counsel to the bride: hearken, forget your own people and father’s house, for the king desires your beauty—bow to him as your lord. The daughter of Tyre and the rich among the people will seek her favor with gifts.

Verse 13-15

The king’s daughter is “all glorious within,” her clothing wrought with gold; she is brought to the king in raiment of needlework, with virgin companions following, brought with gladness and rejoicing into the king’s palace.

Verse 16-17

The king will have children instead of fathers, made princes throughout the earth; the psalmist promises to make his name remembered in every generation, so the people will praise him forever and ever.

4 · MEANING & APPLICATION

Meaning.

A human royal wedding becomes, in Scripture’s own reading, a window into Christ’s eternal, righteous kingship and His covenant love for His people, pictured as a bride called to forsake old loyalties for new devotion to Him. Beauty, joy, and celebration are not incidental to this vision—they are essential to how Scripture pictures the relationship between Christ and the Church.

Application for life today.

Read this psalm with an eye toward Christ as the true King whose throne is “for ever and ever” and whose love for righteousness defines His reign. Consider what it means, as the Church, to be counseled like the bride in verses 10–11: to “forget” old, competing loyalties in favor of wholehearted devotion to Christ. Let the joy and beauty of this wedding imagery correct any picture of the Christian life as merely dutiful rather than also genuinely glad.

5 · REFLECT & RESPOND

Write your answers in the space below. There are no “right length” answers—honesty before God is the aim.

1. How does seeing Christ as the king of verses 6–7 (per Hebrews 1) shape your confidence in His reign over your circumstances?

2. What old loyalties or attachments might God be asking you to “forget” (v. 10) for the sake of wholehearted devotion to Him?

3. Where in your spiritual life could you use more of this psalm’s sense of joy and celebration rather than mere obligation?

Name: _____ Date: _____ Group / Church: _____

Sources: King James Version (public domain); Matthew Henry, Commentary on the Whole Bible (themes summarized); Expository themes consistent with MacArthur Study Bible tradition (paraphrased, not quoted). Scripture: King James Version (public domain).